This table gives us a pertinent and interesting insight into the financial condition of subjects under the Tīmūrid rule. If we refer to Table A.3, it is clear that although the wealth of Hindustan wasn't drastically low as compared to the past (although it dropped), the GDP/capita growth was negative between AD 1500 and AD 1820. It was negative twice from AD 1913 to AD 1950. Of course, this is a very well-acknowledged fact that Bharat under British colonialism had people turning poor although the ruling government kept accumulating wealth. The same cannot be denied about what the Tīmūrid colonialists were doing. This is well supported by many statements by various foreign travellers and court historians of that time. People would be surprised to know how systematically the Tīmūrids drained Indian wealth, including the huge money spent on Hajj and to please the Amirs of Mecca. After his victory over the Lodi, Babur owned massive wealth. Perhaps, he was awestruck looking at so much wealth. Persian historian Firishta (of the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries) has said:

> *Babur left himself stripped so bare by his far-flung largess that he was nick-named Qalandar.*

Although this matter will be dealt with in much detail in upcoming volumes, here I am just going to give a glimpse of the wealth drain by the Tīmūrids right from Babur. The *Baburnama* has spoken in detail about the looted wealth:[*]

> May 12th, on Saturday the 29th of Rajab the examination and distribution of the treasure were begun. To Humāyūn were given 70 lakhs from the Treasury, and, over and above this, a treasure house was bestowed on him just as it was, without ascertaining and writing down its contents. To some begs 10 lakhs were given, 8, 7, or 6 to others. Suitable money-gifts were bestowed from the Treasury on the whole army, to every tribe there was, Afghān, Hazāra, ʻArab, Bīlūch, etc. to each according to its position. Every trader and student, indeed every man who had come with the army, took ample portion and share of bounteous gift and largess. To those not with the army went a mass of treasure in gift and largess, as for instance, 17 lakhs to Kāmran, 15 lakhs to Muḥammad-i-zamān Mīrzā, while to ʻAskarī, Hindāl and indeed to the whole various train of relations and younger children went masses of red and white (gold and silver), of plenishing, jewels, and slaves. Many gifts went to the begs and soldiery on that side (Tramontana). Valuable gifts (saughāt) were sent for the various relations in Samarkand, Khurāsān, Kāshghar and ʻIrāq. To holy men belonging to Samarkand and Khurāsān went offerings vowed to God (nuẕūr); so too to Makka and Madīna. We gave one shāhrukhi for every soul in the country of Kābul and the valley-side of Varsak, man and woman, bond and free, of age or non-age.

With time, Babur's people had begun to show discontent about staying in Hindustan and hence he called a council to resolve the matter. He has written about it in the *Baburnama*:[*]